

PHASES OF THE MOON

The Moon seems to get larger and smaller in the sky, but this illusion is caused by the fact that we can only see the face of the Moon that faces Earth. One half of the Moon is always bathed in sunlight, but most of the time only part of the sunlit area is visible from Earth.



WAXING CRESCENT
Only a thin sliver of the sunlit part of the Moon is seen from Earth.



FIRST QUARTER
The sunlit portion increases to show half of the Moon's hemisphere lit up.



WAXING GIBBOUS
The sunlit part increases – now more than half of the Moon is visible in the sky.



FULL MOON
A full side of the Moon is now visible. This is halfway through the lunar month.



WANING GIBBOUS
Turning away from Earth again, the lit-up section of the Moon begins to decrease.



LAST QUARTER
Rising only around midnight, this half-lit Moon is brightest at dawn.



WANING CRESCENT
This marks the near completion of the Moon's orbit around Earth.



NEW MOON
The lit half of the Moon is completely hidden from Earth at this point.

WE ALWAYS SEE THE SAME FACE OF THE MOON FROM EARTH – IT IS KNOWN AS THE “NEAR SIDE” OF THE MOON

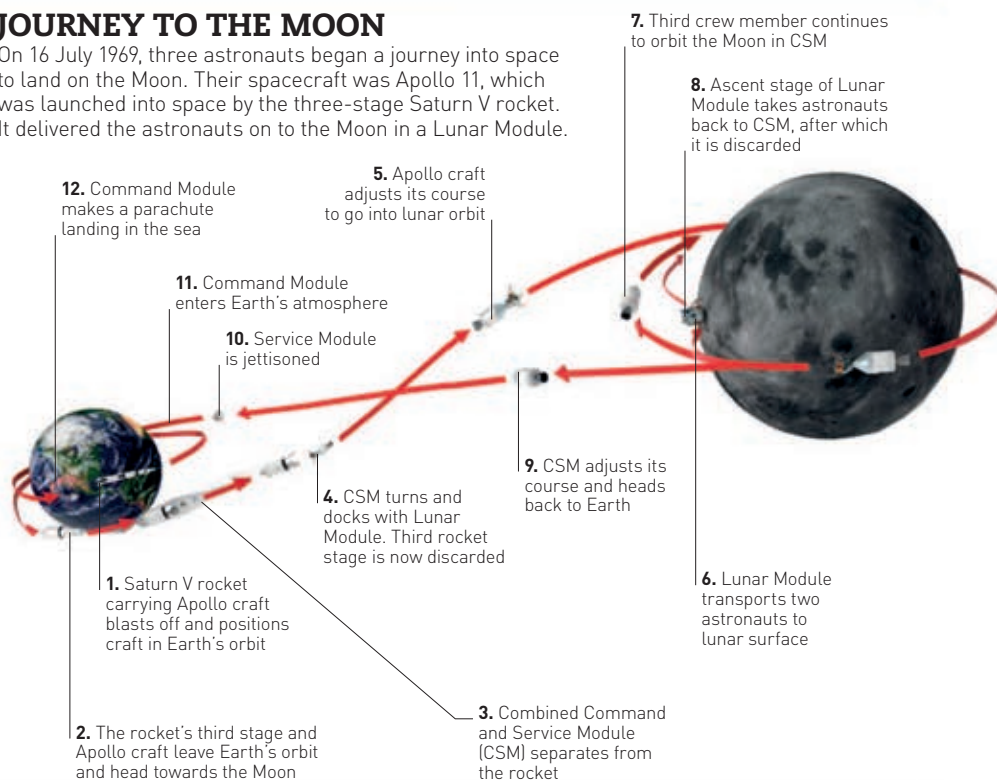


Darker areas are “maria” – smooth, low-lying areas (like seas without water)

The Lunar Highlands are hilly regions with lots of craters

JOURNEY TO THE MOON

On 16 July 1969, three astronauts began a journey into space to land on the Moon. Their spacecraft was Apollo 11, which was launched into space by the three-stage Saturn V rocket. It delivered the astronauts on to the Moon in a Lunar Module.



MEN ON THE MOON

In 1972 the crew of Apollo 17 landed on the Moon and stayed there for three days. They completed three successful excursions to examine craters and the Taurus Mountains.

ASTRONAUT EUGENE CERNAN ON THE LUNAR ROVING VEHICLE, 1972



TRUE OR FALSE?

People have had theories about the Moon since they first looked up at the skies in ancient times. Modern science has helped us work out which Moon myths are true and which are false.



FULL MOON CAUSES LUNACY
Research by scientists has proved there is no link between madness and the full moon.



MOON AFFECTS THE OCEAN TIDES
The Moon's gravity does affect the tides of waters on Earth.



ALIENS INHABIT THE MOON
Samples of the Moon taken by astronauts show no trace of other life, past or present.



YOU WEIGH LESS ON THE MOON
“Weight” depends on the pull between two gravitational forces. The Moon's gravity is less than Earth's, so you would weigh less.



THE MOON IS DRIFTING AWAY FROM EARTH
The Moon is moving away from us by 3.8 cm (1.5 in) per year.



THE MOON HAS A DARK SIDE
The Moon spins on its axis, so every part of it is exposed to the Sun at some point during rotation.

MOON MISSIONS

In the second half of the 20th century, there was a “Space Race” between the USA and the Soviet Union (USSR) to launch crafts, satellites, and people into space. In 1959 the USSR landed a space probe on the Moon, and in 1969 the USA landed people on the Moon. Since then, other countries have sent spacecraft to find out more about the Moon.

THE LAST TIME A MAN LANDED ON THE MOON WAS IN 1972

	AGENCY	SUCCESSFUL MISSIONS
	NASA (USA)	27
	RFSA (USSR/RUSSIA)	20
	CNSA (CHINA)	3
	JAXA (JAPAN)	2
	ESA (EUROPE)	1
	ISRO (INDIA)	1